

Rcd 5/19/00 wpl

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(this is a two page report-click at the bottom for page 2)

7-0 (A)

CFO-RC FILE X: _____

RESULTS: _____

Print this page and then fill out. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species (please include common and scientific name):

AMERICAN WOODCOCK - *Scolopax minor*

Date(s) of Observation: April 13 -

Number of birds seen: one Sex: male Plumage: breeding

Exact location: East Ryan's Pond at Rocky Ford State Wildlife Area

County: Otero Nearest town: Rocky Ford Elevation: 4,000

Length of observation: Time(s) of observation:

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: SEE ATTACHMENT

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position): Dust + later

Optical equipment used: 8x42 Celestron Regal binos / Leica APO scope

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 150 to 10 ft.

Was bird(s) photographed? NO If so, have you submitted photos?

Who took the photographs?

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred:

Bird seems to stay in a grassy marsh area

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

see journal

[click here for page 2 of this form](#) / [Back to the CBRC Home Page Links](#)

Rcd. 5/17/00
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Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

page 2

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

see attached journal

Describe birds call or song:

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): Called up Paul site to check call on April 13.

This report is from notes made during ☒ or after ☐ observation, or later from memory ☐

Date of written report: May 12, 2000

Reporting observer: Stanley W. Oswald

Signature:

St W Oswald

Address:

1208 Washington Ave.
Rocky Ford, CO 81067

Send report to:
Colorado Birds Record Committee
c/o Bill Lisowsky
2919 Silverplume Dr.
Ft. Collins, Co. 80526

[Back to the CBRC Home Page Links](#) / [back to page 1 of form](#)

American Woodcock at Rocky Ford State Wildlife Area

April 13, 2000

Heard it give *peent* call about six times at 8:15 p.m.

Rcd 5/17/00 wpe

April 14, 2000

Bird began to call about 7:50 p.m. Located it below East Ryan's Pond dam. It made at least four display flights, returning each time to same general area to give *peent* call again. Bird was spotted in the air during at least two flights and was seen dropping to the ground against a light western sky. Witnessed by Mark Janos, Brandon Percival, Tony Leukering, Doug Faulkner, Chris Wood, Larry Semo (and his wife?), Bob Dickson and Stan Oswald. Wood made recordings of call on ground and in flight with directional mike. We left at 8:20 p.m.

April 15, 2000

It began to call at 7:54 p.m. and made several flights before we left. Flight sound was a twittering that got fainter as bird got higher. It made a distinctive twittering when it was descending. *Peent* call was always given on the ground. 22 persons observed the display (two from the previous night attended).

April 16, 2000

Bird began calling at 7:52 p.m. Slight breeze out of the west. It made two display flights before it got too dark to see, both began with climb just south of our position. Shape of the bird with long bill and rapid wing beat could be seen easily. 15 observers (three from previous nights).

April 17, 2000 (5th day)

Woodcock began calling at 7:50 p.m. It was spotted flying to the east above ground, landing about 50 from its usual calling spot. Walt Wilson was able to find it in his scope. Black bars on top of the head were obvious, with long bill and dead leaf pattern on back. It would flip its head back each time it uttered the *peent* call. When it turned and faced us, its lighter underparts made it very visible against the fire-blackened grass. Thru binoculars we watched it take off and fly within ten feet of us, then climb straight up into the sky over our heads. It made a couple more flights before we left. There were five observers (two from previous nights).

April 18, 2000

Wind was blowing out of the south-southwest at about 30-40 miles per hour. At times it was difficult to stand on the bank of the dam. Bird began to *peent* at about 8 p.m. but it was difficult to hear with the wind. We did not see it fly. Five observers (two from previous nights). There was a full moon.

April 19, 2000

A bit windy at 7:45 but it died down and was calm. Overcast with just a bit of clearing in the west. 51 degrees. Bird began calling at 7:50 p.m. and made four display flights before it stopped at 8:13 p.m. Overcast sky made it difficult to spot and we did not see bird. It seemed to make its display flights more to the south than before. Three observers (all from previous night).

April 20, 2000

Bird still displaying around 7:56 p.m. Watched it make three display flights.

April 21, 2000

Bob Brown reported bird observed by five persons, Lea Ann Brown, Bob Spencer, John Vanderpoel and Edge.

April 22, 2000 (10th day)

One person, Dave Elwonger, reported hearing the bird.

April 23, 2000

Cloud bank in the west, but otherwise clear and calm. Woodcock began to call at 7:58 p.m. and continued to call and make display flights thru 8:30 p.m. Saw it twice against the lighter western sky as it was returning to the ground. On its fourth flight it went back up in display flight twice rather than returning to the ground to give its peent call.

April 24, 2000

Clear but 5-10 mile per hour wind out of the north. Woodcock began calling at 7:59 p.m. and made four flights before we left. It took off into the wind and we were able to follow it as it rose against the lighter western sky for the first three flights. It first climbs at about a 30 degree angle, then goes straight up and drifts back over point it took off from, then descends with fluttery flight alternating with sideslipping to about 30 ft. when it drops straight in. Tina Jones and friend and I were observers (55 persons or more have seen/heard it so far).

April 25, 2000

Clear with strong breeze out of the northeast. Woodcock began calling at 8 p.m. and made first flight at 8:10 p.m. It climbed to the east before circling back over its takeoff spot. Watched it with binoculars all the way. Two observers.

April 26, 2000

Some high clouds, cloud bank low in the west. Slight breeze out of the northeast. Woodcock began calling at 7:59 p.m. and made first flight at 8:08 p.m. Was able to see it on its first three flights as it took off towards the pond. Watched it land on the first flight but unable to

discern it on the ground. Don Mullineaux and his wife observed bird with me.

April 27, 2000 (15th day)

Bird began calling at 7:58 p.m. and made its first flight at 8:10 p.m. Watched it make three flights. Slight breeze out of the northeast again so it took off right towards pond and was easy to spot. One observer

April 28, 2000

60 degrees and some high clouds, clear strip to the west. No wind. Woodcock began calling at 7:58 again. It took off towards the west. We were able to see it on its first flight when it came back over the display area but after that it was lost against the dark clouds. It made four flights before stopping at 8:15. A barn owl flew low over the display area at 8:10 and the woodcock stopped its peent call for about 30 seconds. It made one more flight and then stopped when the owl stayed in the area. Eight observers (seven new, 64 total)

April 29, 2000

Woodcock was reported seen by Gene Rutherford at about 8 p.m. It was visible on several flights with a late lightning storm providing a backdrop (seven observers, 73 total)

April 30, 2000

Apparently it is light level that triggers the woodcock display. This evening there was a heavy overcast with light rain. The bird began to peent at 7:52 p.m. and made four flights before 8:10 p.m. it took off to the west but was easy to pick up once it got above the display area. A snipe was also displaying in the same area. One observer.

May 1, 2000

Woodcock made one peent call at 7:52 p.m. and another at 7:56 p.m., then began its regular calling (every three to five seconds) at 7:58 p.m. I was able to follow the bird all the way to the ground in the binoculars its first two flights but each time it simply disappeared once it got on the ground. It took off twice to the north, twice to the northeast (right past us) and once to the east. We saw it on all five flights but on the last two it disappeared into the dark above. The barn owl again made a pass at about 8:15 p.m. but it was not right over the woodcock and the woodcock did not interrupt its display. Some very high clouds but otherwise clear, calm. Seven observers (six new, 79 total).

May 2, 2000 (20th day)

Clear with breeze out of the northeast, 60 degrees. Woodcock began calling at 8:06 p.m. and made six flights over the next 20 minutes. It was easy to follow on the first three. On the first two flights it flew due east, then switched to a northerly direction. Richard Stevens

finally showed up with photographer Jim Malone in tow. Malone had a 600 mm f.4 lens with a 1.4 converter on it but was unable to find the bird on the ground. He took a couple of flash photos while it was flying but didn't know if it was actually in the viewfinder. Seven observers (six new, 85 total).

May 3, 2000

Clear, calm, 60 degrees. I got there late, at 8:15 p.m. and bird was already calling. Dick Schottler said it had begun to call about 10 minutes before. He said he had heard a couple of possible peent sounds from grassy marsh to the east just before 8 p.m. and that he and two other persons there had seen the bird fly in to the display grounds from the east before it began its regular peent ground call.

Woodcock made at least four flights, taking off to the southeast. Located it on the first two but after that didn't see it, just heard it. Six observers, (three new, 88 total).

May 4, 2000

Schottler arrived at the site at 5 a.m. and said the bird was calling and displaying till about 5:20 a.m., then it disappeared. He was able to see it just on the last flight. First it has been found in the morning (sunrise is at 5:57 a.m.)

Woodcock began to call at 8:07 p.m. this evening and made four flights by 8:30 p.m. No wind so bird took off mostly to the west and was difficult to locate going up. We saw it three times high above the display area and watched it come down and disappear when it got below the horizon. Seven observers, including Leukering, Faulkner and Wood (three new, 91 total).

May 5, 2000

Clear and calm. Woodcock made a couple of widely spaced peents at about 7:52 p.m. and began to call regularly at 7:58 p.m. It made at least four flights. On the first three we were able to follow the bird all the way to the ground and actually see it on the ground (Kellner and Browns were there). Seven observers, (four new, 95 total)

May 6, 2000

Bird displayed around 8 p.m. this evening. According to three ladies I talked to as they were coming back to the parking lot at 8:30 p.m. it only flew once. Other people at Lamar the next day (on CFO trip) said it didn't make a display flight at all. Seven observers, 102 total

May 7, 2000 (25th day)

Woodcock gave peent sound first at 7:58 p.m. but didn't begin to call steadily until 8:03 p.m. It didn't make its first flight till 8:19 p.m. and only made two flights after that before falling silent about 8:35 p.m. Strong breeze out of the west with some clouds and a cloud bank on the western horizon. We were able to see the bird on the

first two flights high overhead, and I heard it all three times. Five observers, four new, 106 total.

May 8, 2000

Rained most of the afternoon, cleared some by evening but still low clouds scudding to the west. Cloud bank on west horizon and 55 degrees. Walked down to the edge of the dam embankment at 7:50 p.m. and watched it fly in from the southeast at 7:58. Found it on the ground in binoculars at about 30 ft. Could clearly see its black eyes set high on the head and cinnamon-orangish under parts. Wide dark brown and tan stripes on the back. Didn't seem to have very sharply defined black bars on head. It began to peent, flipping its head back and to the right and opening its bill each time it made the call. It also made a low cluk sound, rather like the call of a hen turkey, immediately before the peent sound. Sometimes it made the cluk sound alone.

It made a display flight at 8:13 p.m., coming back to within 20 feet of where it took off. I left and it made four more display flights as I walked back around the pond. I could still hear the sound of its wings halfway back to the parking lot at 8:25 p.m.

May 9, 2000

Woodcock was on the display grounds by 7:55 p.m., began to peent at 7:59 and made first flight at 8:13 p.m. Wind was from the east so it took off that way before climbing high overhead. Found it on the ground after the first flight. Bird was continuing to display at 8:30 p.m. Clear, 60 degrees.

May 10, 2000

Woodcock made a couple of peent sounds from about 50 yards east of its display grounds at 7:47 and 7:51 p.m. It began to sound off regularly just after 8 p.m. Didn't see it arrive in the display area, it is possible that it walked in. Wind was fairly strong out of the west so the bird took off away from me when it flew. Didn't see it at all on its first flight and spotted it coming down on its second flight. Saw it land (it drops straight down from about 40 to 10 ft. and then glides to a chosen landing spot, twisting or fluttering a bit to reach it). It was up displaying again when I left. 60 degrees.

May 11, 2000

No evidence of the bird. It had made appearances on 28 straight days and was seen or heard by at least 106 persons.